**Step 1: Restart the PC**

A restart clears temporary files, stops unnecessary background processes, and refreshes system resources.

1. Save your work and close all open applications.
2. Restart the computer from the Start menu.
3. After restarting, check whether the PC performance has improved.

**Step 2: Check Resource Usage**

High CPU, memory, or disk usage can make a PC slow.

1. Press **Ctrl + Shift + Esc** to open **Task Manager**.
2. Review the **Processes** tab.
3. Look for applications using unusually high CPU, Memory, or Disk resources.
4. Close unnecessary applications if they are not required.

**Step 3: Disable Unnecessary Startup Programs**

Too many startup applications increase boot time and reduce performance.

1. Open **Task Manager**.
2. Select the **Startup Apps** tab.
3. Identify programs that are not needed during startup.
4. Right-click the program and select **Disable**.
5. Restart the computer.

**Step 4: Free Up Disk Space**

Low storage space can reduce system performance.

1. Open **Settings** > **System** > **Storage**.
2. Delete temporary files using **Storage Sense** or **Disk Cleanup**.
3. Remove unused applications.
4. Empty the Recycle Bin.
5. Ensure at least 10–20% of the drive remains free.

**Step 5: Scan for Malware**

Malware can consume system resources and slow down the PC.

1. Open **Windows Security**.
2. Select **Virus & threat protection**.
3. Run a **Quick Scan**.
4. If problems continue, perform a **Full Scan**.

**Step 6: Check for Windows Updates**

Updates often include performance improvements and bug fixes.

1. Open **Settings**.
2. Go to **Windows Update**.
3. Select **Check for updates**.
4. Install any available updates.
5. Restart the PC if prompted.

**Step 7: Update Device Drivers**

Outdated drivers can affect overall performance.

1. Open **Device Manager**.
2. Expand the hardware category.
3. Right-click the device and select **Update driver**.
4. Install available updates and restart the computer.

**Step 8: Optimize the Hard Drive**

Drive optimization improves performance, especially for HDDs.

1. Search for **Defragment and Optimize Drives**.
2. Select the system drive.
3. Click **Optimize**.
4. Note: SSDs are optimized automatically and should not be manually defragmented.

**Step 9: Check System Health**

Corrupted system files can slow down Windows.

1. Open **Command Prompt** as Administrator.
2. Run:

sfc /scannow

3. Wait for the scan to complete.
4. Restart the computer if repairs are made.

**Step 10: Reset the PC (Last Resort)**

If performance remains poor after all troubleshooting steps, resetting Windows may resolve persistent software issues.

1. Open **Settings** > **System** > **Recovery**.
2. Select **Reset this PC**.
3. Choose **Keep my files** or **Remove everything**.
4. Follow the on-screen instructions to complete the reset.

**Additional Tips**

- Keep antivirus software up to date.
- Uninstall software you no longer use.
- Limit the number of browser tabs and extensions.
- Upgrade from an HDD to an SSD for a significant performance improvement.
- Add more RAM if the system frequently runs out of memory.

If the PC is still slow after completing these steps, the issue may be caused by aging hardware or a failing storage drive. Consider running hardware diagnostics or consulting the PC manufacturer's support resources.